



Staff Report

TO: Honorable Mayor and Members of the City Council
FROM: Christopher Ramos, Chief of Police
BY: Don Crow, Assistant Director Community Services and Sarah Lower, Support Services Supervisor Police Department
DATE: August 18, 2026
SUBJECT: Interim Animal Sheltering Services Contract and an Agreement for Architectural Services for the Design of a City-Operated Animal Shelter

Description: Consider approval of a one-year interim animal sheltering services agreement with Haven Pet Center and an agreement with Higginson Architects, Inc. for architectural and engineering design of a municipal animal shelter within Building E.

Motion:

If the City Council determines that staff's recommendation is appropriate, the following motions are provided:

I move to approve a one-year agreement with Haven Pet Center for interim animal sheltering services in an amount not to exceed \$246,000, and authorize designated City staff to approve additional veterinary and medical expenses up to \$3,000 per month; and,

Award a professional services agreement to Higginson Architects, Inc. for architectural and engineering services associated with the conversion of Building E into a municipal animal shelter in an amount not to exceed \$71,800; and,

To authorize the City Manager to execute both agreements, establish a contingency equal to 10% of each agreement's not-to-exceed amount, \$24,600 and \$7,180 respectively, and approve change orders and administrative amendments within the authorized contingencies.

Recommendation:

Staff recommends approval of the one-year interim sheltering agreement with Haven Pet Center and the architectural and engineering agreement with Higginson Architects,

Inc. These actions will restore needed shelter capacity while advancing the phased development of a locally operated, full-service Animal Services Division and Shelter that improves customer service, local control, and operational reliability. Staff will provide Council with an in-depth analysis and proposed budget for the expanded shelter prior to award of a construction contract.

Discussion:

For more than a decade, the City contracted with Ramona Animal Shelter for animal sheltering services. In 2024, the provider shifted its focus to rescue and adoption and stopped accepting City animals. Since then, Beaumont has operated with three standard kennels and two temporary emergency kennels, which provide only limited short-term capacity. Staff explored other providers throughout Southern California but was unable to secure a replacement. Haven Pet Center is agreeable to a one-year agreement, with any continuation available only month to month at this time. Staff recommends approval of this agreement as an interim solution while a city shelter facility is constructed.

The existing kennel facility was not designed or staffed as a full-service shelter and cannot adequately accommodate extended stays, quarantine, medical treatment, behavioral concerns, or specialized placements.

Animal housing requires care 365 days per year, including weekends and holidays. Responsibilities include feeding, cleaning, exercise, health monitoring, medication, intake and identification, recordkeeping, veterinary coordination, owner reclaims, and placement services. The City must maintain adequate daily and backup coverage regardless of the number of animals housed.

The City has two Animal Control Officers working staggered 4/10 schedules, with both officers regularly on duty only one day each week. Transporting animals outside Beaumont or assigning officers to routine kennel care impacts coverage and may delay calls, investigations, and enforcement. A City-operated division would establish dedicated animal-care staffing and more reliable seven-day coverage.

Animal Intake and Facility Capacity

Before the City lost contracted sheltering services, animal impounds averaged approximately 500 annually in 2023 and prior years. Modified intake practices reduced impounds to approximately 365 in 2024, and annual intake averaged approximately 200 during 2025 and 2026 due to the City's limited capacity. This reduction reflects operating constraints and does not indicate a comparable decline in community need.

Staff anticipates approximately 365 annual animal intakes when full-service sheltering is restored. The preliminary Building E plan contains 24 kennels, including quarantine capacity, and appears capable of meeting projected demand if length of stay is actively

managed through owner reclaims, adoptions, foster placements, and rescue partnerships. The design phase will evaluate average and peak populations, quarantine and isolation needs, surge capacity, and potential expansion.

A Beaumont shelter would provide residents with a single location to deliver stray animals, search for lost pets, reclaim animals, adopt pets, obtain licensing information, and access other animal services. Local operations would also eliminate the need to transport animals out of town and improve coordination among field officers, shelter personnel, pet owners, veterinarians, fosters, and rescue organizations.

Direct operation would allow the City to establish its own service standards, operating hours, intake and care policies, staffing levels, fees, and performance expectations. It would also support volunteer and foster programs, adoption events, public education, and partnerships for vaccination, microchip, and spay-and-neuter services.

Development Plan

Staff recommends a one-year agreement with Haven Pet Center to provide interim shelter capacity while the City facility is developed. Haven would accept up to 50 animals per month, or 600 annually.

The agreement totals \$210,000 for sheltering and administrative services and includes up to \$36,000 for actual veterinary expenses, for a total amount not to exceed \$246,000. Veterinary expenses exceeding \$1,000 in a month would require prior staff approval and may not exceed \$3,000 per month.

Haven would accept eligible stray animals delivered by City officers or Beaumont residents and provide adoption services following the required holding period. Owner surrenders and excluded animals would be handled according to the agreement and Haven's established policies.

The agreement provides interim capacity but does not eliminate the City's responsibilities for intake, temporary housing, transportation, excluded animals, field response, or daily animal care.

Facility Design and Operational Planning

Staff recommends awarding a professional services agreement to local firm Higginson Architects, Inc. in an amount not to exceed \$71,800 to design the conversion of Building E at 550 East 6th Street into a 24-kennel municipal animal shelter. As part of the procurement process, the City requested design proposals from qualified local firms. Four proposals were received and evaluated, with Higginson Architects, Inc. determined to be the top proposal based on the firm's qualifications, cost, and proposed services.

The design will address the improvements specific to the proposed animal shelter, including kennels, quarantine and examination areas, animal-care support spaces, staff

and public areas, an outdoor dog run, drainage, sanitation, and security. Although the shelter is anticipated to occupy only a portion of the building, the project will also identify and address necessary building-wide improvements, including a new roof and HVAC systems, as these improvements are not practical to implement only within the portion of the building occupied by the shelter. Where feasible, the remaining portions of the building will remain adaptable for another municipal use. The design period is anticipated to be approximately three months.

Staff will also develop an operating plan addressing staffing and seven-day coverage, veterinary and shelter services, customer service, volunteer and foster programs, equipment, vehicles, technology, and ongoing costs. The duties and classification of the existing project manager position will be evaluated for management of the City-operated division.

When design, cost estimates, operational planning, and bid documents are complete, staff will return to the City Council to consider the construction contract, project and operating budgets, staffing, funding, schedule, and transition plan. Following Council approval and completion of the facility, the City would transition to a locally operated, full-service Animal Services Division.

Fiscal Impact:

The Haven Pet Center agreement would not exceed \$246,000, consisting of \$210,000 for sheltering and administrative services and up to \$36,000 for actual veterinary expenses. The Higginson Architects, Inc. agreement would not exceed \$71,800. A Midyear budget adjustment will be necessary to appropriate the funding necessary to cover the sheltering agreement.

The combined agreement amount is \$317,800, plus a 10% contingency of \$31,780, for a total authorization not to exceed \$349,580. Funding will be provided from the current ACO budget (2000-7068) and CIP Project F26-04, respectively.

Construction, equipment, staffing, and ongoing operating costs have not yet been determined and will be presented with the proposed construction contract.

Alternatives:

The City Council may decline either agreement or provide alternative direction. Without the interim agreement, the City would continue operating with limited shelter capacity. Delaying the design agreement would extend the timeline for establishing local operations.

Attachments:

- A. Haven Pet Center Agreement
- B. Professional Services Agreement with Higginson Architects, Inc.